

Envisage'09

Festival To Celebrate Big Ideas



▲ Inauguration ceremony, graced by Dr. Dinesh Singh, Director, UDSC (third from left)

E (endeavour) N (navigate) V (vision) I (innovation) S (strife) A (analyse) G (graft) E (excel)! The acronym explains clearly what young minds with a vision aim at, while striving for excellence.

Envisage'09, a national level technical festival organised on February 28 and March 1, 2009, proved to be yet another milestone for the Institute of Informatics and Communication (IIC), South Campus, University of Delhi (DU), to bring together the youth, academia and industry. It saw participation from enthusiastic and motivated groups of people from all over India, including DU, the IITs and the NITs. There was an overwhelming response from 137 teams from across the country, comprising over 250 participants.

With "Think, Connect, Create and Share" as the motto, and open source as the underlying theme, the fourth edition of Envisage brought the concept of 'Inclusive Development' into focus.

The journey begins

This two-day mega fest, comprising a plethora of events, was aimed at providing a platform to promote the spirit of ideas.

At the inauguration ceremony, eminent personalities from industry and academia shared a common platform. Professor Dinesh Singh, director, University of Delhi, South Campus, Dr Sanjeev Singh, faculty, IIC, and coordinator of Envisage'09, Dr MK Dass, teacher in charge, IIC, kept the audience enthralled.

After the inaugural formalities, a number of events were flagged off. C manics (on C coding), Bugfix (the debugging challenge) and Object-o-mania (object-oriented programming) saw the clash of the programming champs, while 'What Lies Beneath' (a logic and reasoning contest) and 'No Ugly Duckling' (an open source challenge) laid emphasis on analytical and reasoning skills. Eureka, the project presentation, saw a gruelling battle as the short-listed candidates explained their ideas and innovations to a large

audience, under the microscopic scrutiny of the judges.

'Battlefield', the LAN-based gaming contest, witnessed an intense clash of wits, precision and teamwork, with gaming enthusiasts leaving no stone unturned in their hunt for supremacy. 'Junkyard Wars', the PC assembling contest, attracted a number of participants aiming to become hardware champions.

Day 2 kicked off with 'Termi-net-er' (a networking and socket programming contest) and the much-awaited IT and communication quiz, COMMIT, which saw quite a number of enthusiastic spectators cheering the participants on. 'Cobweb', the Web designing contest, saw Internet geeks design websites on pre-defined themes.

The theme this time was to develop a framework. While the day was filled with fun and frolic, the night involved sipping mugs of tea and munching on snacks while tackling various tough algorithmic problems based on the theme of Slumdog Millionaire.

'Ad-Vantage' (creating ads) and 'Die Hard' (a series of fun games) were the biggest crowd pullers at Envisage'09, filling the halls to capacity. The crowds roared with appreciation at some spectacular performances by

the contestants. 'ClickIt' (a digital photography contest) also attracted a number of participants, showcasing their imaginative skills.

The journey continues...

Envisage has pioneered the idea of providing a platform for those in the open source universe in the country, to meet and influence each other. If the momentum set here is anything to go by, do fasten your seat belts, for Envisage continues to grow bigger and better, and the level of excitement will only increase in the years to come. **END**

By: Shivani Mehrotra

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▲ Waiting with bated breath for the results: The Closing Ceremony